NO ONE EVER ASKS US TO REVIEW

OPEN SCIENCE 2025/2026

Tommaso Barbato
Ilaria De Dominicis
Regina Manyara
Chen Qinghao
Yu Peize

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BLOOM

As researchers, we all know that the peer review system is **carried on the backs** of the **most expensive people's** time.

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130,800,757 hours spent reviewing

21,800,126 total reviews

in 2020

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It is an issue that everybody addressed (or will address) during their life as a researcher...

1

“Journal editors disproportionately request reviews from senior researchers, whose time is arguably the most valuable.” (Aczel et al., 2021, p. 6)

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“Senior researchers on average show up more often in literature searches”

“Editors favor people they are familiar with, and younger researchers have had less time to become familiar to editors”

Aczel et al. Research Integrity and Peer Review (2021) 6:14 https://doi.org/10.1186/s41073-021-00118-2

2

“Journal peer review, therefore, takes longer and longer because the system fails to keep up with academia’s changing demographics” (Aczel et al., 2021, p. 6)

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2008 - Average reported time spent reviewing was 8.5 h
2009 - Randomly selected reviewers indicated that the reported average time spent on the last review was 6 h
2016 - Median reviewing time is 5 h

Aczel et al. Research Integrity and Peer Review (2021) 6:14 https://doi.org/10.1186/s41073-021-00118-2

In order to address this problem, we encourage the audience to push publishers, editors and stakeholders to consider reviewer types beyond what has been established as familiar.

Thank you!

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